

C&S Wholesale Grocers, LLC

DATA CLASSIFICATION POLICY

ARVIN BANSAL
C&S WHOLESALE GROCERS, LLC
Keene, New Hampshire

C&S Wholesale Grocers, LLC

1. INTRODUCTION

This policy defines a framework to classify, label, and protect information assets managed by C&S Wholesale Grocers. It ensures:

- Consistent handling of company data across all business units
 - Protection against unauthorized access, use, disclosure, alteration, and destruction
 - Compliance with applicable laws and regulations including CCPA, GDPR, HIPAA, and PCI-DSS
 - Data lifecycle management that supports business continuity, operational efficiency, and risk mitigation
 - Appropriate governance over data generated or used by Artificial Intelligence (AI) platforms, including Gemini, Google AI Studio, and Google Vertex AI
-

2. SCOPE

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, vendors, and third parties accessing or handling C&S information, including:

- Procurement & Category Management
- Supply Chain & Logistics
- Warehouse Automation & Operations
- Retail Execution & Customer Fulfillment
- Human Resources
- Corporate Finance & Audit
- Technology & Analytics
- AI and Machine Learning initiatives involving internal or third-party data

All data types—physical, digital, structured, or unstructured—stored or transmitted using C&S-owned or managed systems, including cloud AI platforms like Google Cloud Platform (GCP), are covered.

C&S Wholesale Grocers, LLC

3. CLASSIFICATION LEVELS

C&S data must be classified into one of the following levels:

Level	Description	Examples
Public	Non-sensitive data authorized for external/public distribution	Job postings, press releases, published product catalogs
Internal Use	Operational data not sensitive but not meant for public sharing	SOPs, warehouse schematics, training materials, internal memos
Confidential	Business-sensitive data that could impact operations or finances	Vendor pricing, supply chain metrics, audit reports, employee records
Restricted	Highly sensitive or regulated data requiring maximum protection	Customer PII, payment data, health records, system credentials, model training datasets containing personal information

All systems and users must handle data according to its classification.

C&S Wholesale Grocers, LLC

4. DATA LABELING & HANDLING REQUIREMENTS

The following table outlines how data at each classification level should be labeled, stored, transmitted, accessed, and disposed of to ensure appropriate protection based on its sensitivity.

Classification	Label Example	Storage	Transmission	Access Control	Disposal
Public	[PUBLIC]	No restrictions	No restrictions	Open	Delete when obsolete
Internal Use	[INTERNAL]	C&S-controlled drives	TLS recommended	C&S employees only	Secure deletion
Confidential	[CONFIDENTIAL]	Encrypted drives	TLS required	Role-based access (RBAC)	Secure wipe/shredding
Restricted	[RESTRICTED]	AES-256 encryption	TLS + IP controls	Limited to approved roles + MFA	Crypto wipe, legal hold if needed

C&S Wholesale Grocers, LLC

5. DATA CLASSIFICATION MATRIX

This matrix provides example data types from various business units and maps them to the appropriate classification levels to guide consistent application of this policy across departments.

Data Type / Business Area	Public	Internal	Confidential	Restricted
Product promotions (Marketing)	✓			
Warehouse blueprints (Operations)		✓		
Supplier pricing agreements			✓	
Procurement contracts			✓	
Customer payment data				✓
Employee medical records (HR)				✓
Distribution logs (Logistics)		✓		
Financial forecasts & reports			✓	
Access logs / server credentials				✓
Internal communications (email, chat)		✓		
AI model outputs impacting customers			✓	
AI training data (user-submitted)				✓

C&S Wholesale Grocers, LLC

AI prompts with sensitive content				✓
-----------------------------------	--	--	--	---

C&S Wholesale Grocers, LLC

6. RETENTION & DISPOSAL STANDARDS

The table below defines how long each data category should be retained and the method by which it must be securely disposed of after its retention period.

Data Category	Retention Period	Disposal Method
Procurement Contracts	7 years post-termination	Secure archive or crypto wipe
Customer Order Records	5 years or per SLA	Cryptographic wipe
Warehouse Activity Logs	12 months	Secure deletion
Employee HR Records	7 years after departure	Shredding or secure digital wipe
Surveillance Footage	30–90 days	Automatic deletion
Vertex/Gemini Prompt Logs	30 days (unless extended use case)	AI-specific secure wipe

7. ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

- **Data Owners:** Ensure accurate classification of data within their domain (e.g., Procurement, HR, Logistics, AI project owners)
- **IT & Security Teams:** Implement and maintain access controls, encryption, DLP, and secure disposal mechanisms
- **Employees & Contractors:** Handle all data according to its classification and applicable procedures
- **Compliance & Legal:** Provide regulatory guidance and support audits or legal holds as required

C&S Wholesale Grocers, LLC

- **Third Parties:** Must adhere to C&S contractual obligations including DPAs and relevant safeguards
- **AI Developers:** Ensure prompt inputs, training data, and model outputs follow classification and privacy rules

8. ENFORCEMENT

Violations of this policy may result in disciplinary action, including access revocation or legal penalties. Exceptions must be formally approved and risk assessed by IT Security and Legal.

9. REVIEW & REVISION

This policy is to be reviewed annually or upon significant changes to:

- Regulatory landscape (e.g., CCPA/GDPR updates)
- Business operations (e.g., acquisitions, system overhauls)
- Threat landscape or data handling practices
- Technology deployments including AI, ML, and GCP-based tools

C&S Wholesale Grocers, LLC

Document Revision	Reviewer	Description of Changes	Date
1	Jahnvi Thakur	Policy creation	08/07/2025
2	Chandan Kochhar	Review and update	08/07/2025
3	Arvin Bansal	Review and Approval	08/10/2025
4	Diptanil Paul	Annual Review	11/24/2025

Policy Title: Data Classification Policy
Status: Active
Policy Owner: IS Security and Compliance
Original Issue Date: 08/08/2025

SOP#
Version: 1.0
Department: IT
Effective Date: 08/08/2025
Last Review: 11/24/2025